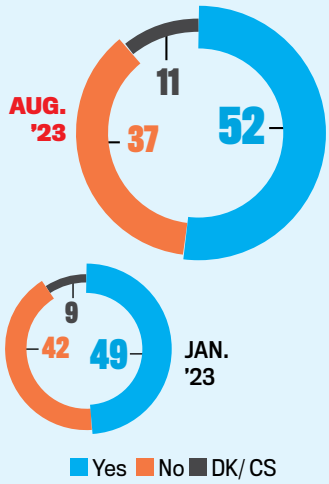
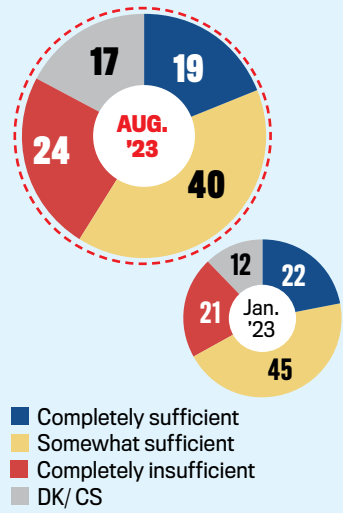
Q. Do you think the central and state governments should give more "freebies"?



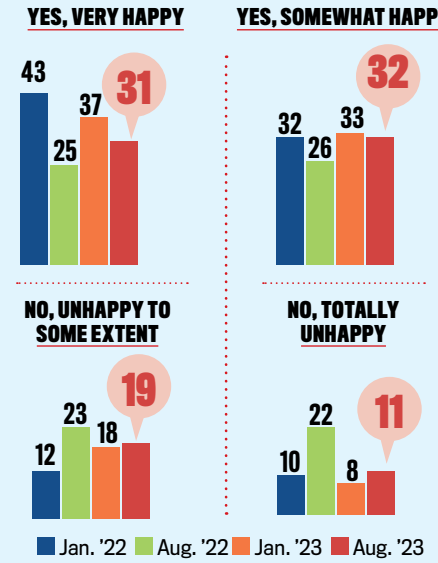
The share of people voting for government freebies goes up over the last MOTN poll

Q. Do you think we are doing enough to protect the environment?



There is a rise in those who think our environmental efforts fall short of goals

Q. Do you consider yourself happy?



The happiness quotient of the MOTN respondents sees a dip compared to Jan. '23

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS (don't know, can't say)

favour of the LGBTQ+ community, the most significant being the decriminalisation of same-sex relations in 2018. In the latest MOTN poll, 40.5 per cent of the respondents are opposed to legalising same-sex marriages in India, while 33.9 per cent are in favour of it. Notably though, 46 per cent of respondents aged between 18-24 years support same-sex marriages.

Data protection and privacy in the digital space are other emerging areas of concern. A whopping 68.4 per cent of the respondents in August 2023 are worried about their privacy, compared to 55.7 per cent in January this year. Similarly, an overwhelming 66 per cent of the respondents think that the Union government has been trying to control content on social media. Of them, while a substantial 40.7 per cent see that control as being exercised to a great extent, 25.2 per cent believe this is happening to 'some' extent.

A MAJORITY OF THE RESPONDENTS STILL CONSIDER THEMSELVES HAPPY, BUT THE NUMBER HAS DIPPED FROM 75 PER CENT IN JANUARY LAST YEAR TO 63 PER CENT TODAY

On the environment front, too, there is room for improvement. While 18.8 per cent feel what the Centre is doing to achieve its climate goals is sufficient, another 39.5 per cent think it is 'somewhat' sufficient. Both these figures have registered a drop of 2.9 and 5.9 percentage points, respectively, since January 2023. Those who think it is completely insufficient account for almost a quarter of the total respondents (23.6 per cent) this time, indicating that the country still has some way to go in addressing environmental concerns.

Overall, the MOTN poll's findings, which shine an equal light on India's recent achievements as well as its setbacks, point to the state of flux the country is in today. And this seems to have reshaped the happiness quotient of the respondents too. A majority of them still consider themselves happy, but that share has dipped from 75 per cent in January last year to 63.2 per cent this time. As India completes 75 years of its independence, policymakers would do well to address the myriad factors that have led to this decline in happiness if they really wish to set the country on a path of inclusive, sustainable and all-round growth. ■